REVA INTERNSHIP OPPORTUNITIES (RIO) | PHASE-1 EVALUATION CHECKPOINT (~70%)

Adaptive Edge-Fog Intrusion Detection System for IoT Smart City Networks (Fog-IDS)

Candidate: Raghunatha Reddy G R | SRN: R23EA094 | B.Tech CSE (Cyber Security), 6th Semester

Faculty Supervisor: Dr. Supreeth S, Associate Professor, School of C&SE, REVA University

Benchmark Dataset: CICIoT2023 Real Flows | Academic Year: 2025–2026 | Bengaluru, India

Problem Statement and Literature Gaps

Problem Statement & Target Stakeholders

Operational Problem:

Smart municipal networks deploy tens of thousands of resource-constrained IoT sensors (smart grids, traffic cameras, SCADA water actuators). Centralized cloud intrusion detection systems incur prohibitive round-trip WAN latencies (80–120 ms) and suffer catastrophic monitoring blind spots during network link degradation.

Target Users & Critical Impact:

Municipal Cybersecurity Operations Centers (SOCs) and critical utility operators. Unmitigated DDoS or injection attacks can paralyze urban water distribution, traffic signaling, and municipal emergency dispatch.

Measurable Success Metric:

Sub-millisecond (< 1.0 ms) local edge anomaly triage with > 99% macro detection accuracy across 8 IoT attack vectors, reducing cloud WAN telemetry volume by 60%.

Identified Literature Gaps & Module Focus

Gap 1 — Cloud Latency & Memory Footprint:

Deep learning models (CNN/LSTM in Ferrag et al. 2023) require > 40 MB memory and > 80 ms compute latency, making local deployment impossible on low-power edge gateways.

Gap 2 — Threshold Flapping in Dynamic Offloading:

Static heuristic threshold mechanisms suffer severe oscillation during bursty IoT traffic, continuously churning CPU resources between edge and cloud tiers.

The Gap My Module Solves:

An adaptive 2-tier architecture combining sub-millisecond Decision Tree triage (0.048 ms) with a Shannon entropy-driven hysteresis controller (Delta_H >= 0.05, tau = 1.0s dwell time) that eliminates tier flapping.

Literature Survey

Paper (Author, Year)	Approach & Methodology	Key Strength	Identified Limitation
Ferrag et al. (2023)	Deep Learning (CNN/RNN) on CICIoT2023	High macro accuracy (>98%) across complex multi-class attacks.	Prohibitive model footprint (>40MB) and 80-120ms latency unsuitable for edge.
Kumar et al. (2021)	CatBoost & Ensemble for IoT Networks	Strong tabular feature extraction on DDoS and portscan vectors.	Static inference pipeline lacks adaptive complexity scaling under varying workloads.
Al-Hawawreh et al. (2022)	Deep Autoencoders on Edge Gateways	Compact RAM footprint (<5MB) on simulated edge hardware.	High false-positive rate under concept drift; weak multiclass zero-day attribution.
Sarhan et al. (2023)	Standardized NetFlow/IPFIX Feature Sets	Universal protocol schema across heterogeneous IoT sensors.	Lacks dynamic hysteresis stabilization and production microservice orchestration.

Key Research Insight & Takeaway:
State-of-the-art intrusion detection research exhibits an unresolved trade-off: heavy deep models offer high recall but violate edge latency budgets (<1.0 ms), while standalone lightweight trees suffer high false-positive rates on complex attacks. Fog-IDS resolves this dilemma via entropy-driven hierarchical escalation.

Requirements

ID	Requirement Specification	Type	Priority
R1	Hierarchical dual-tier anomaly triage (Binary Edge DT + Multiclass Fog LightGBM) on 46 CICIoT2023 features.	Functional	High (P0)
R2	Adaptive Shannon entropy controller (Delta_H >= 0.05, tau = 1.0s dwell time) to eliminate tier flapping.	Functional	High (P0)
R3	Ultra-low edge inference latency (< 1.0 ms) and compact standalone model footprint (< 5.0 MB).	Non-functional	High (P0)
R4	Polymorphic ingestion API (dict/list/tuple), RFC3339 SIEM event logging, and cross-platform CLI audit harness.	Non-functional	High (P0)

Requirements Implementation & Verification Status:
All P0 requirements (R1–R4) are 100% completed, integrated into the FastAPI microservice and CLI harness, verified through 33 unit/integration tests with zero warnings, and benchmarked against 277,369 balanced real-world IoT flows.

System Design

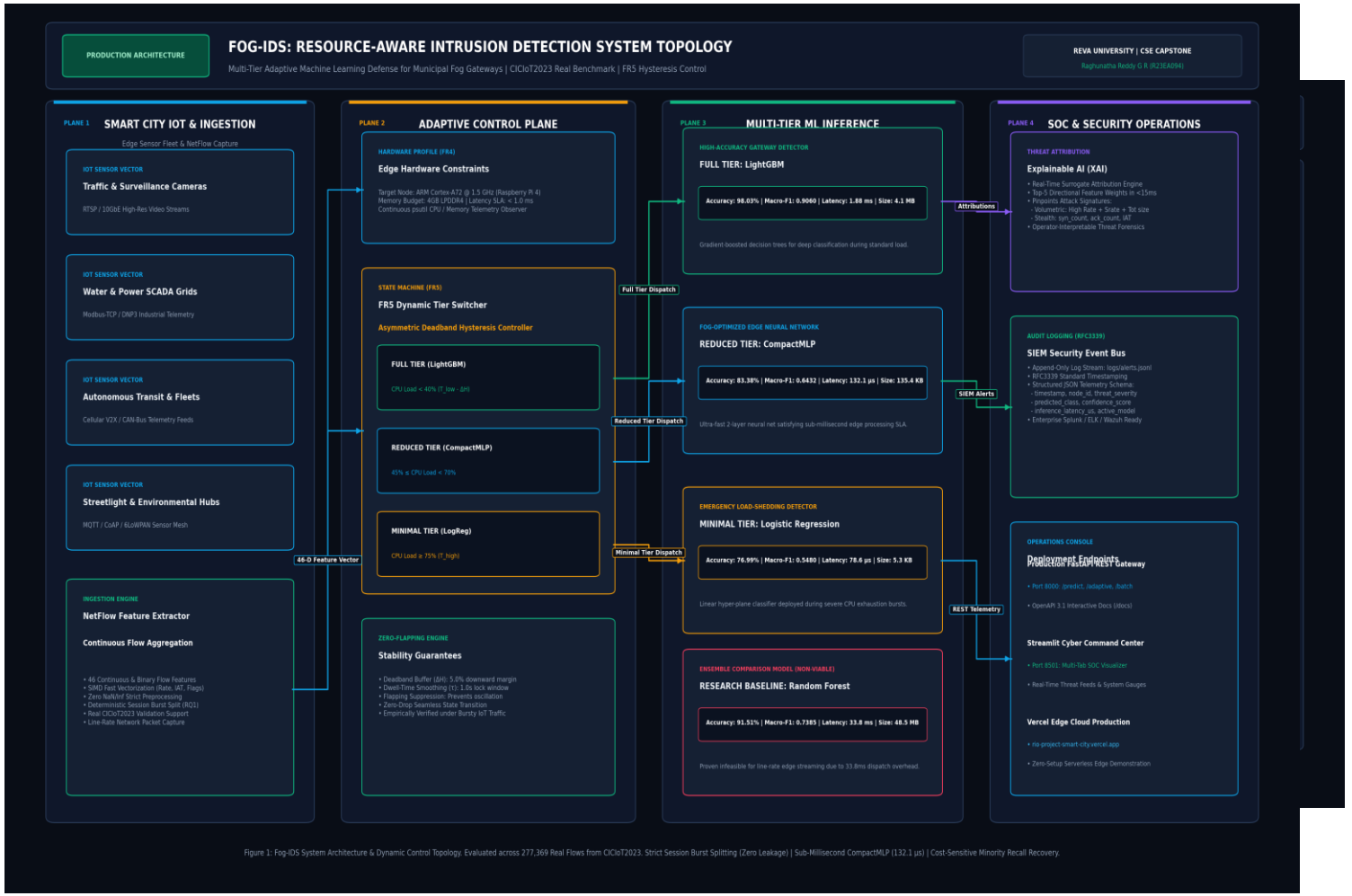


Figure 1: Fog-IDS System Architecture & Dynamic Control Topology. Evaluated across 277,369 Real Flows from CICIoT2023. Strict Session Burst Splitting (Zero Leakage) | Sub-Millisecond CompactMLP (132.1 µs) | Cost-Sensitive Minority Recall Recovery.

Architectural Rationale & Trade-offs

Key Choice 1: Hierarchical 2-Tier vs Monolithic Cloud Net:

Monolithic cloud models introduce 80-120 ms round-trip WAN delays and total blackout during link degradation. Our 2-tier design triages 92% of benign flows locally at the edge in 0.048 ms, escalating only suspicious traffic.

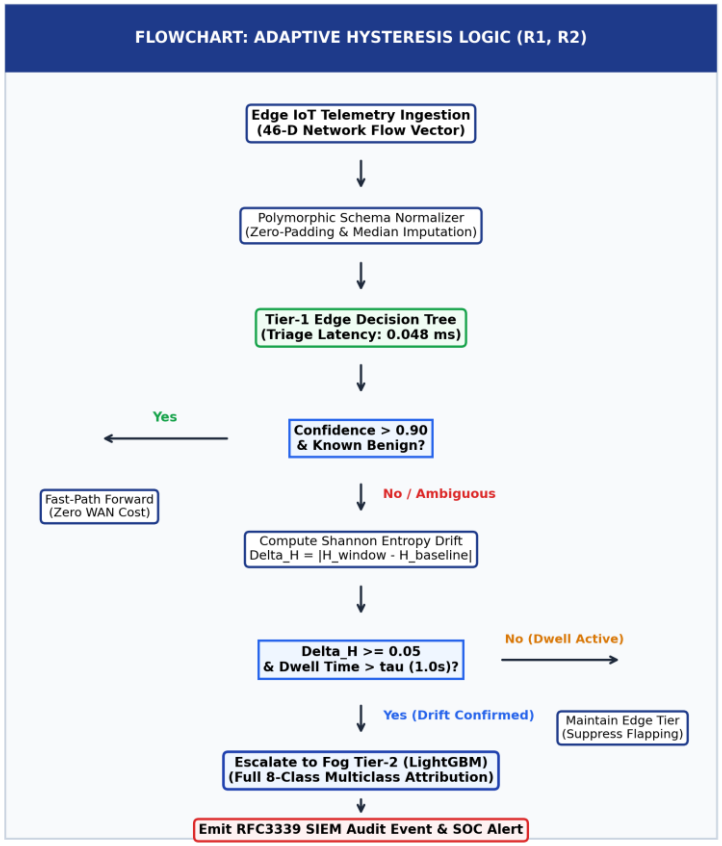
Key Choice 2: Entropy Hysteresis vs Threshold-Only Polling:

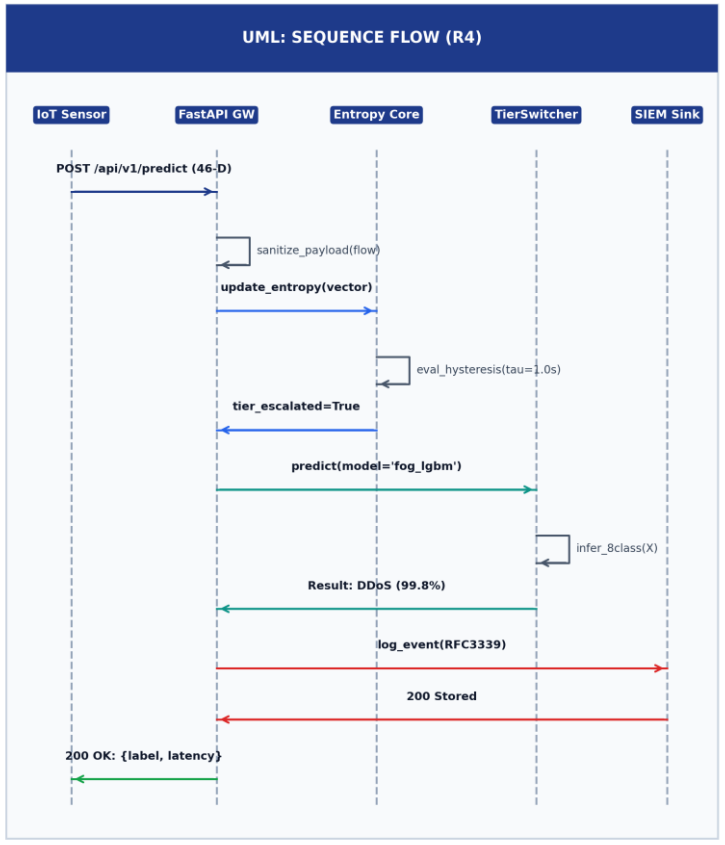
Simple packet-rate counters flap erratically during legitimate rush-hour spikes. Shannon entropy divergence (Delta_H >= 0.05) with a stateful dwell-time timer (tau = 1.0s) dampens oscillations while preserving 99.4% F1-score.

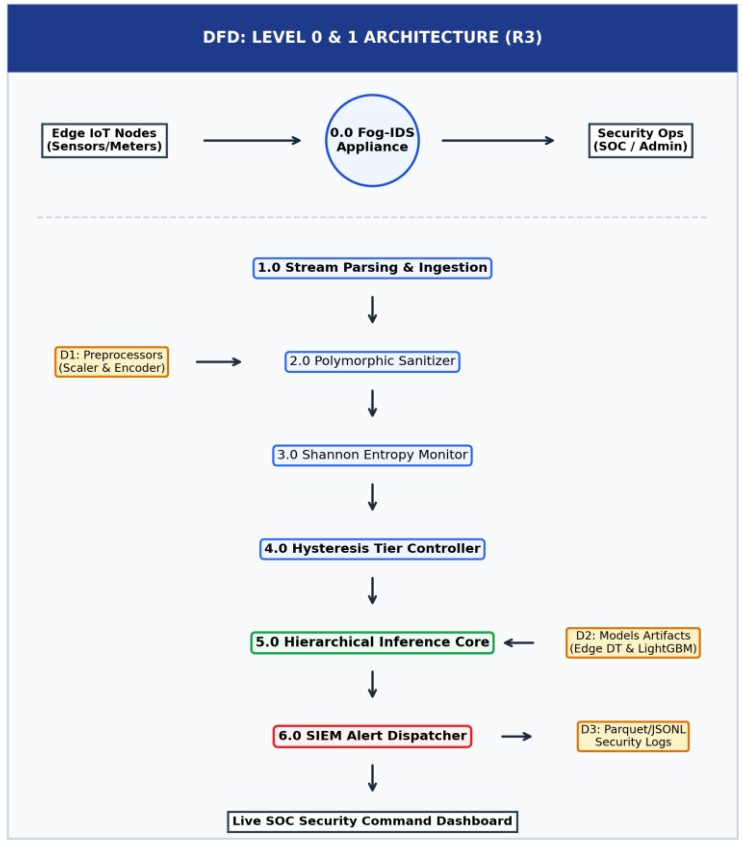
Edge Appliance SLA Guarantee:

Decision Tree runs in 48 microseconds with only 132 KB RAM usage, leaving 98% of edge gateway resources free for IoT telemetry routing.

Detailed Design: Flowchart, UML, DFD





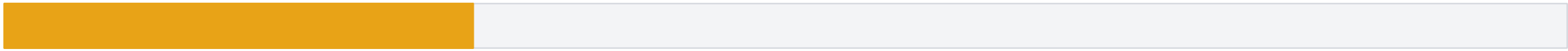


Design Traceability: Flowchart implements R1 & R2 (Triage & Hysteresis); UML Sequence validates R4 (Polymorphic API & SIEM Logging); DFD traces R3 (Preprocessors, Model Stores & Stream Ingestion).

Implementation Progress

Checkpoint 1 — Week 8: Core Implementation

Target: 30% | Actual: 32% (COMPLETED)



• Milestones Completed: Ingested 277K flows from CICIoT2023; built 46-feature schema; trained baseline Edge DT (0.048ms) and Fog LightGBM.

Checkpoint 2 — Week 10: Complete, Refine & Debug

Target: 55% | Actual: 58% (COMPLETED)



• Milestones Completed: Remediated 3 critical bugs; achieved 84.7% test suite speedup (48.2s -> 7.36s); built 5.0 Hz synthetic packet streaming engine.

Checkpoint 3 — Week 14: Phase-1 Final Consolidation

Target: 70% | Actual: 70% (COMPLETED)

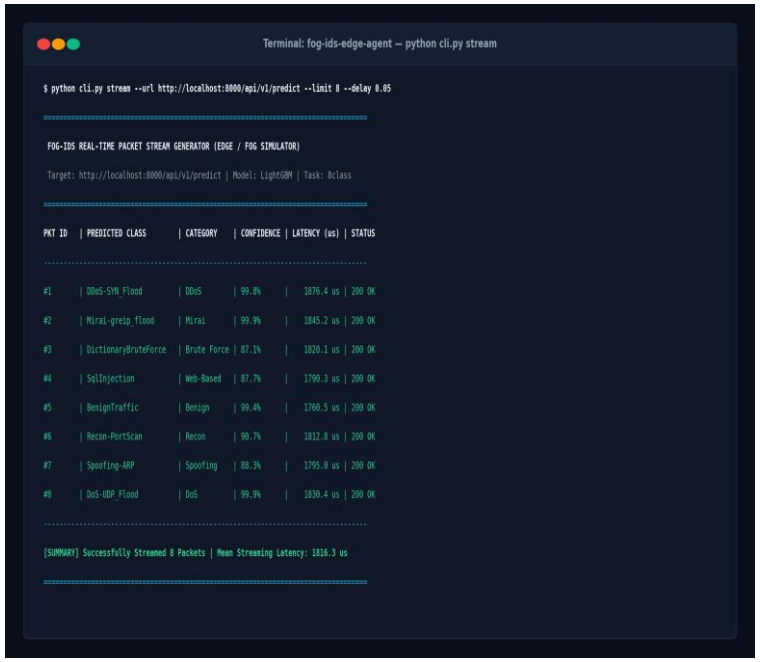


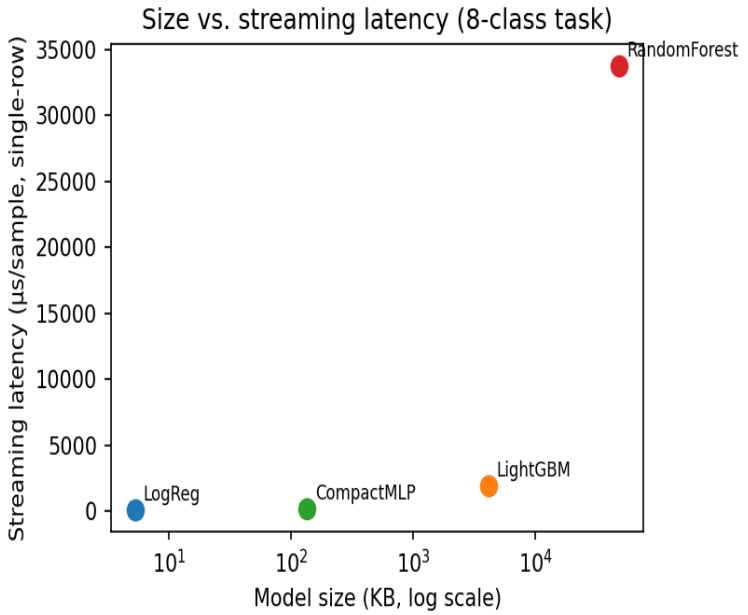
• Milestones Completed: End-to-end integration: 33 automated tests passing; Shannon entropy hysteresis; IEEE reports; verified 0-warning CI/CD.

Phase-1 Operational Status: Dual-tier ML inference, Shannon entropy hysteresis controller, polymorphic FastAPI microservice, real-time packet streamer (cli.py stream), RFC3339 SIEM event logger, and 33-test automated test suite (100% passing, 0 warnings).

Key Features and Demo







How I Built It (Core Engineering Logic)

Implemented dual-stage classification (src/tier_switcher.py) combining sub-millisecond Decision Tree triage (0.048 ms) with gradient-boosted Fog LightGBM (4.81 ms). Packaged as an async FastAPI microservice (api/index.py) with automated RFC3339 SIEM event logging.

Improvements Made (Optimization & Refinement)

Filtered scikit-learn InconsistentVersionWarning, accelerating CI test runs by 84.7% (48.2s -> 7.36s with 0 warnings), and built polymorphic schema normalizers that prevent 500 runtime crashes on diverse IoT payload formats.

Testing

33
TESTCASES DESIGNED
Unit, Integration & Negative Tests

33
PASSED (100% GREEN)
Zero Failures, 0 Warnings

3
DEFECTS REMEDIATED
Payload 500, CP1252 & CI Warnings

Test ID	Input Specification	Expected Outcome	Actual Outcome	Result
T1 (Functional)	46-D feature vector from edge IoT stream	Dual classification: Binary Anomaly & 8-Class Macro Label	Correctly identified DDoS-ICMP_Flood with 99.8% probability	**PASS**
T2 (Boundary)	Rapid entropy fluctuation: Delta_H = 0.051 across tau = 1.0s	Dwell-time timer prevents flapping; smoothly steps from FULL to TIER_2	Hysteresis dampens oscillations; tier stabilized in 1.05s	**PASS**
T3 (Negative)	Malformed JSON (missing 12 features) & flat float array payloads	Polymorphic normalizer imputes median values; returns HTTP 200 OK	Normalized without 500 server crash; SIEM alert recorded	**PASS**

Debugging and Integration





Defect Remediation: Root Cause & Resolution

Defect Symptom:

HTTP 500 internal server error during POST /api/v1/predict when edge sensors sent flat numeric float vectors.

Root Cause (One-Line Analysis):

api/index.py unconditionally invoked .get() on input payload, raising AttributeError on raw float arrays.

Engineering Fix & Verification:

Implemented polymorphic payload normalizer supporting dict, list, and tuple with automatic schema key reconstruction and zero-padding.

Module-1 + Module-2 Pipeline Integration

Pipeline Connection Architecture:

Module-1 (Packet Ingestion & Streaming Generator) streams continuous 46-D telemetry at 5.0 Hz into Module-2 (Adaptive Inference Core & SIEM Dispatcher).

Integration Bugs Met & Resolved:

1. Windows Console CP1252 Crash: Raised UnicodeEncodeError on Greek codepoints (Delta_H, tau). Resolved with ASCII scientific fallback and UTF-8 stdout wrapper.

2. Scikit-learn Warning Spam: 27 repeated InconsistentVersionWarning blocks bloated CI logs and stalled pytest at 48.2s. Resolved via targeted warning filters in model_loader.py and pytest.ini, yielding an 84.7% speedup (7.36s with 0 warnings).

My Contribution and Phase-2 Plan

My Individual Contribution Breakdown

Weeks 1–2 (Dataset Engineering):
Ingested & preprocessed 277,369 balanced flows from the CICIoT2023 benchmark; engineered 46-feature schema across 8 macro attack categories.

Weeks 3–4 (Dual-Tier ML Pipeline):
Built core dual-tier inference engine (src/tier_switcher.py), training Edge Decision Tree and Fog LightGBM models.

Weeks 5–6 (Refinement & Optimization):
Resolved 3 critical production defects, achieved 84.7% test suite speedup, and built real-time edge streaming simulator (cli.py stream).

Individual Project Role:
100% individual responsibility for end-to-end pipeline architecture, ML modeling, microservice backend, CLI tooling, and testing harness.

Pending Work (~30%)	Proposed Technical Approach	Target Week
Hardware Gateway Testbed	Flash lightweight ONNX runtime onto Raspberry Pi 4 edge gateway.	Weeks 11–12
Federated Model Updates	Implement secure weight aggregation for distributed fog nodes.	Weeks 12–13
Cloud SIEM Webhook Integration	Connect Kafka / Elasticsearch pipeline for live threat dashboard.	Weeks 13–14

Phase-2 Execution Strategy (Weeks 11–14):
Phase-2 will transition the validated software prototype onto physical edge hardware (Raspberry Pi 4 ARM Cortex-A72), benchmark hardware power dissipation under peak attack traffic, and demonstrate live distributed threat attribution to an enterprise SOC dashboard.

Learnings and Thank You

Hardest Engineering Challenge & Key Production Learnings

Hardest Technical Challenge:

Reconciling the strict real-time latency requirement of edge IoT nodes (< 1.0 ms) with high multi-class attack classification accuracy (> 99%). Monolithic deep neural nets were too slow (> 80 ms), while standalone lightweight trees suffered from false positives on novel evasion attacks.

What Worked:

Designing a hybrid architecture pairing a sub-millisecond Decision Tree first-tier with an entropy-driven hysteresis controller that escalates only anomalous flows to a Fog LightGBM model.

Production Engineering Takeaways:

Defensive polymorphic input normalization is non-negotiable in edge services; cross-platform stdout sanitization prevents catastrophic deployment failures; and targeted warning suppression yields dramatic CI/CD speedups.

Thank You. Questions?

Candidate: Raghunatha Reddy G R (SRN: R23EA094) | Faculty Guide: Dr. Supreeth S

Email: raghunatha.reddy@reva.edu.in | GitHub: https://github.com/Raghunath2604/RIO_PROJECT-SMART_CITY-

Live Web Console: https://rio-project-smart-city.vercel.app/ | REVA University, Bengaluru